I decided against it. Pa already knew, I assumed, and Willy had already warned me not to do it.

It's too fast, he'd told me. Too soon.

In fact, he'd actually been pretty discouraging about my even dating Meg. One day, sitting together in his garden, he'd predicted a host of difficulties I could expect if I hooked up with an "American actress," a phrase he always managed to make sound like "convicted felon."

Are you sure about her, Harold?

I am, Willy.

But do you know how difficult it's going to be?

What do you want me to do? Fall out of love with her?

The three of us were wearing flat caps, green jackets, plus fours, as if we played for the same sports team. (In a way, I suppose, we did.) Pa, driving us out into the fields, asked about Meg. Not with great interest, just casually. Still, he didn't always ask, so I was pleased.

She's good, thanks.

Does she want to carry on working?

Say again?

Does she want to keep on acting?

Oh. I mean, I don't know, I wouldn't think so. I expect she'll want to be with me, doing the job, you know, which would rule out Suits*…since they film in… Toronto.*

Hmm. I see. Well, darling boy, you know there's not enough money to go around.

I stared. What was he banging on about?

He explained. Or tried to. *I can't pay for anyone else. I'm already having to pay for your brother and Catherine.*

I flinched. Something about his use of the name Catherine. I remembered the time he and Camilla wanted Kate to change the spelling of her name, because there were already two royal cyphers with a C and a crown above: Charles and Camilla. It would be too confusing to have another. Make it *Katherine* with a *K,* they suggested.

I wondered now what came of that suggestion.

I turned to Willy, gave him a look that said: *You listening to this?*